Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role at Quillstone Payments. I bring six years of experience in analytics and data science, building and evaluating models that support operational and customer-retention decisions. I am particularly interested in applying that experience to AI systems that help merchants get support quickly and help operations teams work effectively.

At Thistlebox, I developed a weekly recipe-level demand forecasting model using LightGBM and calendar features. Operations uses it to inform ingredient ordering; the model reduced WAPE from 23% to 14% and estimated food waste by 9%. I also developed a churn propensity model in XGBoost to target retention offers and validated uplift with a holdout. These projects have involved translating practical needs into model features and evaluation, then communicating results to the teams who use them.

Alongside modelling, I write production SQL in BigQuery and maintain dbt models for the analytics layer. I use Python, Git and Google Cloud through BigQuery, and bring a strong foundation in statistics, feature engineering and experimentation. I would be keen to build on this experience in Quillstone's AI team, working with engineering, data science and product colleagues to develop and operate useful systems for customer support.

Quillstone's emphasis on ownership, pragmatic problem-solving and sharing context across teams particularly appeals to me. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience in applied modelling and analytics could contribute to the team.

Kind regards,
Tobias Mwangi-Hartley